PARABOLA BASS Z Quick Start

Install it, load your captures, and get a modern bass tone in about 10 minutes. Windows 10 / 11, 64-bit.



Three bands, each with its own amp capture: a clean, compressed low end; growl in the mids; grit on top. A cab on the mid and high bands, a graphic EQ on everything.

1 · Install

1. Run **Parabola-Bass-Z-v...-windows-x64.exe**.
2. Windows may show **"Windows protected your PC"** (an unsigned hobby build, not a store app). Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
3. Leave both parts ticked: the **VST3 plugin** (for your DAW) and the **standalone app**. Click Install.

WHAT	WHERE IT GOES
VST3 plugin	`C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3\Parabola Bass Z.vst3`
Standalone app	`C:\Program Files\Parabola Bass Z\`, plus a Start menu folder
Your captures and IRs	`Documents\Parabola Bass Z\NAMs` and `\Cabs` (empty; made for you)

2 · Get captures and a cab IR

Parabola doesn't include any (their licenses don't allow passing them around). Download free ones from **tone3000.com** and unzip them into the folders above:

BAND	USE	EXAMPLE
Low	A clean bass amp (or nothing: clean DI)	Ampeg SVT-CL, "SVT CLEAN"
Mid	A bass drive	Darkglass B7K pack, "B7K Djent"
High	A heavier drive	Darkglass B7K pack, "B7K Heavy"
Cab	A bass cab IR (.wav)	Ampeg 8×10 (D6 mic) or Eden 4×10

3 · First sound

1. **In a DAW:** rescan VST3 plugins (Reaper: Options → Preferences → Plug-ins → VST → **Re-scan**) and put Parabola on your **bass DI** track. It replaces your amp and cab. **Or standalone:** Start menu → Parabola Bass Z, click the **gear**, pick **ASIO** and your interface, tick your bass's input, turn on **Hear yourself**.
2. On each band click **LOAD** (or drag a `.nam` from File Explorer onto the band). On the cab, **LOAD** an IR.
3. Play. Balance the bands with their **Level** knobs, then season with **Drive**.

4 · Getting around

DO THIS	TO
Hover anything	Read what it does (and its value) in the bar at the bottom.
Drag the crossover handles	Move the splits between low, mid and high (defaults 180 Hz and 1.6 kHz).
Power light on a band	Mute it, to hear what the others are doing.
ADV on a band	That band's Bass / Mid / Treble, and its CAB switch.
Drag a knob, double-click	Turn it; reset it.
Click ?	The manual inside the plugin: every part, how it works, settings to try.
Gear	Skins (Foil, Inferno, Hologram, Ram, Ember) and audio settings.
Drag the bottom-right corner	Resize the window (60% to 200%).

5 · If something's off

PROBLEM	TRY THIS
DAW doesn't list Parabola	Rescan VST3 plugins. Check `…\Common Files\VST3\Parabola Bass Z.vst3` exists.
No sound in the standalone app	Gear → **Hear yourself** on; your bass's input ticked; outputs go to your speakers.
Crackles	Three captures need some CPU: raise the buffer (128 or 256).
A band says "File not found"	The capture moved. LOAD it again from its new place.
Too fizzy	Turn the mid / high **Tone** down, or lower the high band's Level.
Uninstall	Windows Settings → Apps → Parabola Bass Z → Uninstall.

> **Want the deep dive?** Start menu → Parabola Bass Z → **Manual** (PDF), or click **?** in the plugin.